

July 10th, 2026
Week 28
Volume 282, Issue 1243

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"A smooth sea never made a skilled sailor"

- Franklin D. Roosevelt

Highlights:

- **Truce breaks.**

The peace lasted three weeks. After Iranian projectiles struck three tankers in the Strait of Hormuz on July 6 and 7, the United States hit more than 80 targets in one night and roughly 90 the next, from Qeshm Island and the approaches to Bandar Abbas to the Chabahar maritime control tower, and revoked the waiver permitting Iranian oil sales. Iran responded with attacks against U.S. military facilities in Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, and Jordan. President Trump, attending the NATO summit, declared the ceasefire over in the morning and reported by evening that Iran wanted a deal "so badly." The truce was over at breakfast and negotiable by dinner.

- **Brent jumps.**

Brent jumped 5.2% to approximately USD 78 per barrel, its biggest daily gain since May, before easing toward USD 77 as traders weighed threats of a renewed blockade and possible strikes on the Kharg Island export terminal against a strait that has not, so far, fully closed. Hormuz transits are declining again, with visible traffic increasingly using Iran-approved routes. The barrel that toured the war and came home has packed again.

- **Rivers rise.**

Freight chose an awkward week to rally. The Baltic Dry Index rose for a sixth consecutive session to 2,875, its highest since June 8, on firmer iron ore and coal demand, with the Capesize index reaching 4,514. The premium that peace spent a month deflating is now repricing from both the cargo side and the war side at once.

- **Yards stall.**

The currencies re-sorted along the old fault line within hours. The Indian Rupee slid to a one-month low near 95.5, with the Reserve Bank defending the level; the Taka held above its former band ceiling near 123.2; and the Lira remained in record territory near 46.7. The Pakistani Rupee alone held near its 2026 best around 278. The June inflation prints, struck during the peace, arrived just as it ended: Turkey eased to 32.11%, its first annual decline since the war opened, while Bangladesh slowed to 9.16%. The disinflation tailwind reached the data on July 3. The war reached back for it on July 7.

At the beaches, the sky has opened. Persistent flooding across Chattogram Division, with rivers above danger levels and warnings extending across seventeen districts, is hampering yard production and thinning demand, while the resumed conflict delivers its familiar knock-on hesitation to owners and the Gulf exit queue alike. The wave counted last week now waits beneath two skies: the weather over the Bay of Bengal and the ordnance over the strait. Detailed market briefs follow on pages 2 through 5.

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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TRUCE BREAKS, RIVERS RISE

BANGLADESH



RIVERS RISE, YARDS STALL

Rivers rise.

The monsoon has turned from a calendar constraint into an operational one. Constant flooding across the Chattogram region is hampering production at the yards, with market reports confirming limited cash buyer demand as plot operators contend with the weather rather than the pipeline. Chattogram Division recorded extremely heavy rainfall within a single 24-hour period this week. The Flood Forecasting and Warning Centre has placed at least seventeen districts under short-term flood warnings, while the Halda, Sangu, Matamuhuri, Feni, and Gomti rivers are running at or above danger levels across Chattogram, Bandarban, Cox's Bazar, and Feni. Landslide risk remains elevated across the hill districts, with heavy to very heavy rainfall forecast for several more days under a monsoon low over the northwestern Bay of Bengal. Beaching cycles have slowed beyond the ordinary seasonal pattern. This is no longer the monsoon merely closing a window. It is the monsoon standing in the yard.

CPI eases.

The macro backdrop, by contrast, improved on schedule. Bangladesh's June CPI eased to 9.16%, with lower food prices slowing overall inflation as the fiscal year closed, while the IMF moved to release USD 1.3 billion following a reform breakthrough, reinforcing the external position alongside reserves near USD 34.12 billion. USD/BDT held above its former band ceiling near 123.2 to 123.3, with the dollar-driven break of Week 27 consolidating rather than extending. The renewed conflict has so far placed less pressure on the Taka than on the Rupee, with the energy pass-through reflected in Bangladesh's 9.16% inflation rather than the double-digit levels Pakistan carried through much of the conflict. The latest available local steel indication remained near BDT 66,000 per ton, equivalent to approximately USD 535 at the prevailing exchange rate. No trading was reported during the latter part of the week as heavy rainfall and flooding disrupted activity across the yards and local steel market.

Wave waits.

The 550-vessel Gulf exit census that gave the deferred wave its first hard number now carries an asterisk. Hormuz transits are declining again as the conflict resumes, visible traffic is concentrating on Iran-approved routes, and the owners who were moving closer to recycling decisions as the war premium eased are now watching that premium rebuild. Chattogram's July 14 to 17 tide window approaches with the yards flood hampered and demand limited, a combination that defers rather than destroys. The Letter of Credit pipeline remains permissive, plot capacity remains available, and the structural second-half setup survives intact beneath the water. The wave now waits on two skies, the one over the Bay of Bengal and the one over the strait, and neither is currently taking instructions from the market.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



RUPEE SLIDES, OIL RETURNS

The rupee has taken the war's return harder than any currency in the basin. USD/INR slid to a one-month low near 95.50, falling 0.6% on Wednesday alone and more than 1% across six sessions, with the Reserve Bank of India reportedly selling dollars through state-run banks near the 95.50 level to slow the move. The stress spread across the asset complex: Indian equities fell 2% in their steepest session of the period, while the ten-year government bond yield rose seven basis points in its largest one-day move in more than three months. The oil-import vulnerability that the peace had pushed into the background is back in the foreground, and the rupee, which spent June trading the dollar's moves, is spending July trading the war's.

Rupee slides.

The arithmetic is unchanged from the spring; only the level differs. Brent near USD 77 to USD 78, against USD 71 a week ago, re-widens the import bill of an economy that buys more than 80% of its crude abroad, and it does so just as the Federal Reserve's June minutes put roughly one-in-three odds on a July hike and two-in-three by September, with the U.S. ten-year yield at 4.565% and the Dollar Index above 101. The rupee is again fighting on two fronts, oil and the Fed, and this week both advanced. India's June CPI, due mid-month, was struck against the peace-era oil environment of June and should still print calm; the July number will carry whatever the strait decides. The war's first act taught the rupee's range. The second act has opened at the weak end of it.

Oil returns.

Local steel plate prices at Alang firmed from INR 36,500 to INR 37,000 during the week, with the USD equivalent rising from approximately USD 383 to USD 388 per ton. India remains the basin's lowest-priced destination, with the gap to Pakistan above USD 310 per LDT. The July 11 to 20 tide window opens as this issue publishes into a market where the monsoon caps beaching, the resumed conflict has suspended the exit-queue mathematics of a week ago, and more than 110 valid Statements of Compliance wait on a routing decision the war has again deferred. Alang's position is unchanged: deepest capacity, strongest compliance, weakest price. What changed this week is the timetable, which now belongs once more to the strait.

Alang waits.

PAKISTAN



RUPEE HOLDS, GULF SHAKES

Gulf shakes.

The war's return arrived at Pakistan's doorstep. Iran retaliated with missile and drone attacks against U.S. military facilities in Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, and Jordan, bringing the conflict back to Gulf waters that frame Gadani's routing lanes, while the Gulf Cooperation Council's condemnation of the attacks confirmed the region's re-entry into the conflict it had spent three weeks exiting. Analysis of Tehran's posture suggests Iran values control of the strait above avoiding escalation, implying that the coming weeks may again be governed by the coercive mechanics that defined the spring: attacks on shipping, strikes in reply, and a waterway whose usability is decided daily. The Gulf proximity that was first a wartime premium and then a peacetime irrelevance is now a live variable again, and its direction has yet to declare itself.

Rupee holds.

Through all of it, the rupee simply held. USD/PKR remained near 278, at or close to its 2026 best, extending the currency's standing as the only one in the basin to have appreciated through the war, the peace, and now the war's resumption. The June CPI turn reported last week, 11.1% annually with an outright 0.3% monthly decline, remains the operative read, while the renewed oil spike retests the import bill from USD 77 rather than USD 126, a materially shallower starting point than the spring shock. The State Bank's 11.5% policy stance, disciplined reserve management, and remittance resilience carried the rupee through the worst quarter in years. The market's early verdict on the second act is that they may carry it again.

Duties digest.

Gadani is spending the week digesting policy and war at once. The July 1 SROs remain the structural story beneath the plate quote: Regulatory Duty relief of roughly USD 12.50 per ton on HR prime and USD 21.50 on wire rod continues to sharpen the competitiveness of imported prime product against locally recycled material, while the scrap-side relief of USD 3.50 to USD 5.50 exerts more moderate pressure. July's realizations will show which channel the breakers feel first. Local steel plate held at PKR 195,000 per ton, near USD 700 on the firm rupee, while the yards continue working through the Jenny Lucky and Ladonna intake. The resumed conflict cuts both ways for Pakistan: it revives the locational calculus that favoured Gadani in the spring, and it revives the shipping hesitation that starved every beach in the basin. Which force wins is the question July will answer.

TURKEY

CPI TURNS, WAR RETURNS



Turkey finally got its number. June CPI printed at 32.11% year-on-year, down from 32.61% in May, marking the first annual decline since the war opened and the lowest reading since March. Monthly inflation eased to 0.99%, the smallest increase in six months. Housing slowed to 45.14% and transport to 31.15% as the post-war oil collapse fed through, while food inflation continued climbing to 35.45%. The print landed broadly in line with expectations and revived market discussion of the central bank resuming its easing cycle after months of emergency tightness. The disinflation tailwind the TCMB waited for all year reached the data on July 3. The war reached back for it on July 7.

CPI turns.

The resumption carries a particular geography for Ankara. President Trump declared the ceasefire over while attending the NATO summit in Turkey, and Brent's jump back toward USD 78 threatens the oil relief that produced June's improvement before it could compound. USD/TRY held in record territory near 46.7, with the lira's managed slide continuing against a dollar strengthened by Federal Reserve rate-hike expectations. The policy rate remains at 37%, while the effective 40% overnight rate continues to do the work. The June print gave the easing argument a hearing. The July print, struck against resumed hostilities and USD 77 oil, will decide whether that argument survives its first witness.

War returns.

At USD 266 to USD 288 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage, and neither the war's end nor its resumption has changed that fact. The Gulf exit queue, whose routing was last week's question, is this week's suspended question, but its eventual answer remains unchanged: the tonnage will move to the sub-continent on price, while Aliaga's share will continue to be determined by EU regulation and Basel Convention compliance. Turkey has now occupied its separate market through a war, a peace, and a second war, which is, at minimum, a demonstration of consistency.

Niche persists.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 28 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Softening	455-460 / LDT	475-480 / LDT	485-490 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Steady	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	Steady	418-423 / LDT	438-443 / LDT	448-453 / LDT
4	Turkey	Softening	266-268 / LDT	276-278 / LDT	286-288 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *The 72.55 million MT of CO₂ emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang is broadly equivalent to the direct emissions from burning approximately **27 billion litres of diesel fuel**.*
- *The 69.16 million tonnes of steel recovered from ships at Alang could produce approximately **576,000 route-km of double-rail railway track**.*
- *The 72.55 million MT of CO₂ emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to removing approximately **15.7 million passenger vehicles** from the road for one year.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 15 – Independence Day	July 11 – July 20 July 27 – August 04

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
August 05 - July Uprising Day August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	July 14 – July 17 July 29 – August 01

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	July 15 - Democracy and National Unity Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of July 10, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	White Star	8,700	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered July 07</i>
2	Vega	8,148	RoRo	<i>Delivered July 03</i>

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 10, 2026

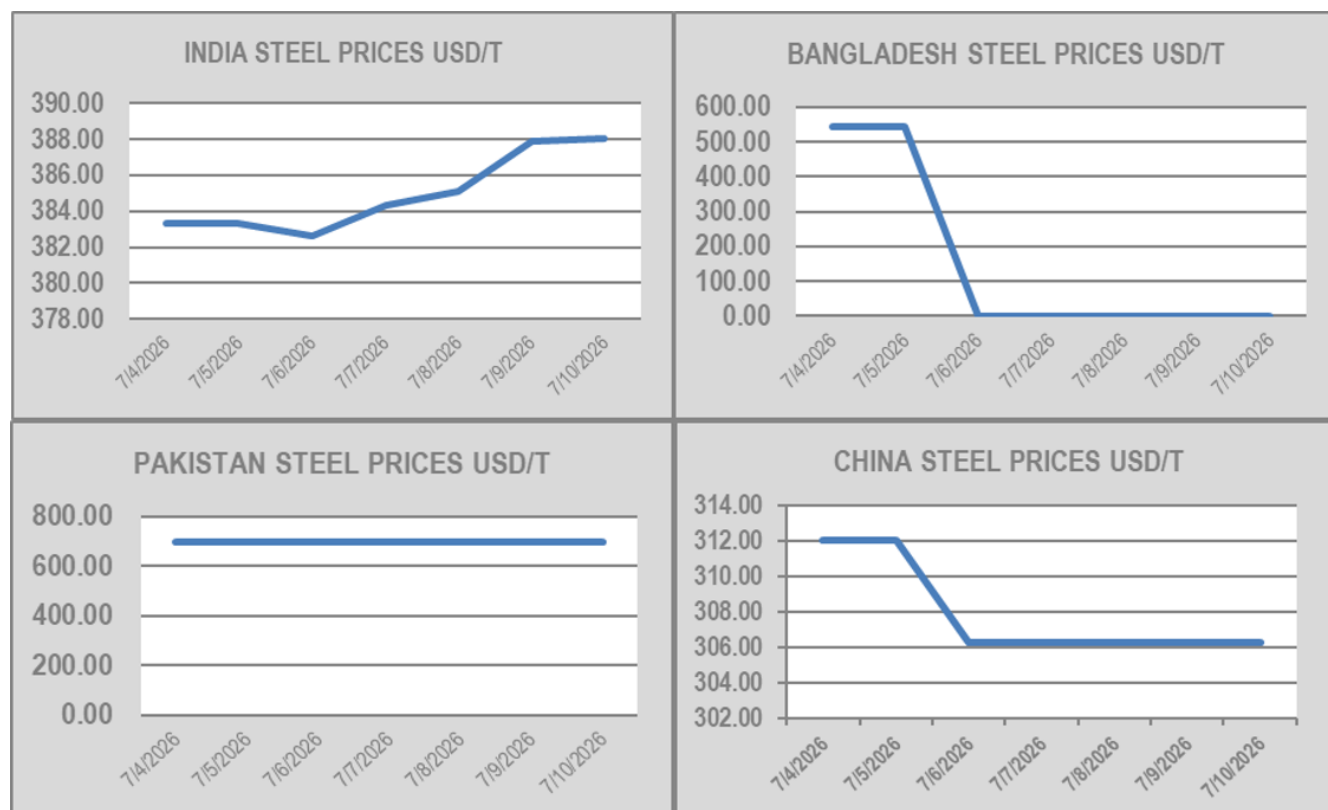
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Meili	903	Multipurpose Cargo	<i>Arrived July 08</i>
2	Bao	9,634	Wood ChipCarrier	<i>Delivered July 08</i>
3	J Chen	4,200	General Cargo	<i>Delivered July 07</i>
4	Fu Hai 8	1,461	General Cargo	<i>Delivered July 07</i>
5	Basel Athena	6,316	Multipurpose Cargo	<i>Delivered July 06</i>
6	Irus	28,805	LNG Tanker	<i>Delivered July 03</i>

GADANI - Port Position as of July 10, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	ILA	6,334	Bulk Carrier	<i>Arrived July 04</i>
2	Jenny Lucky	7,176	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered July 01</i>

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/4/2026	383.32	36,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	543.21	66,000.00	312.10
7/5/2026	383.32	36,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	543.21	66,000.00	312.10
7/6/2026	382.64	36,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	no trading	no trading	306.32
7/7/2026	384.37	36,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	no trading	no trading	306.32
7/8/2026	385.10	36,800.00	696.43	195,000.00	no trading	no trading	306.32
7/9/2026	387.92	37,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	no trading	no trading	306.32
7/10/2026	388.04	37,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	no trading	no trading	306.32



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